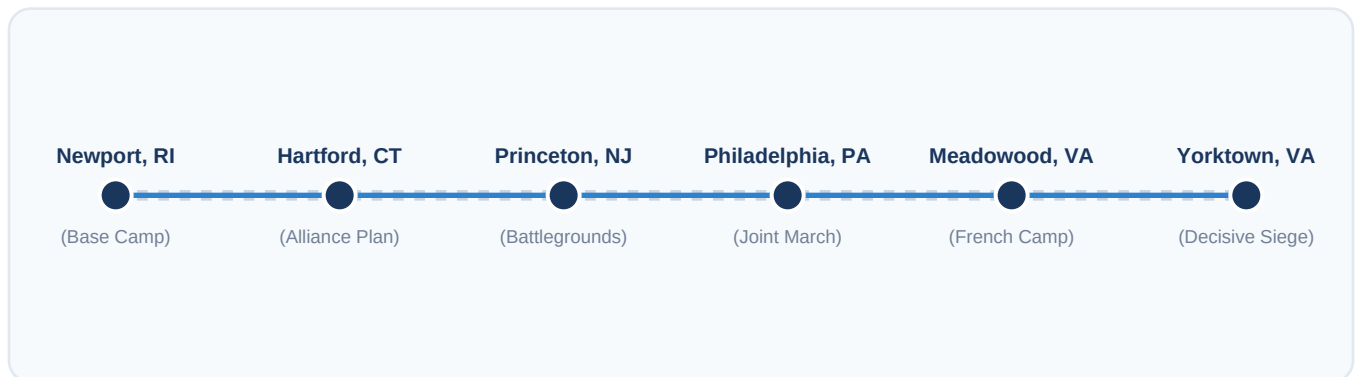


Washington-Rochambeau Revolutionary Route (W3R)

Historical Overview, Geospatial Asset Guide, and Webmaster Briefing

Executive Summary: The Washington-Rochambeau Revolutionary Route National Historic Trail (W3R) is a 680-mile designated corridor tracing the land and water pathways utilized by the allied French and Continental armies in 1781 during the American Revolutionary War. This report outlines the core historical milestones, geographical touchpoints, and strategic recommendations required to compile a high-utility, scannable web presence for this National Trail.

Figure 1: Conceptual Vector Map Matrix of the W3R Corridor



1. Historical Context & Military Alliance

The trail preserves a monumentally complex joint operation that finalized American self-determination:

- **The French Arrival (July 1780):** General Jean-Baptiste de Rochambeau disembarked at Newport, Rhode Island, with approximately 5,300 veteran French troops to reinforce General George Washington.
- **The Strategic March (June 1781):** Departing New England, French forces converged with the Continental Army near the Hudson River, executing a deceptive southward maneuver that caught British forces off-guard.
- **The Victory at Yorktown (September–October 1781):** Allied forces seamlessly integrated with Lafayette's troops to encircle British General Cornwallis, resulting in a world-altering surrender.
- **The North-bound Return (1782):** The formal trail designation comprehensively encompasses the subsequent return trek of French regiments back to New England ports.

2. Corridor Geography & Administrative Boundaries

Logistical constraints of 18th-century dirt roadways required marching columns to move along highly diversified, parallel paths to mitigate road wear and maintain resource supply. Today, the unified National Historic Trail spans a highly complex multi-state footprint cutting across **nine states** and the federal district:

States Encompassed: Rhode Island, Massachusetts, Connecticut, New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Delaware, Maryland, Virginia, and Washington D.C.

3. Major Archeological Hubs & Critical Points of Interest

The following data grid presents the high-priority coordinates recommended for inclusion in interactive web maps, site directories, or localized landing pages:

Key Historic Hub	Role in the American Revolution / Strategic Profile
Newport, RI	Primary landing sector and fortified naval camp where French forces wintered from 1780 to 1781.
Lebanon, CT	Home of the historic Lebanon Green; acted as a pivotal logistical depot and wartime infrastructure nexus.
Princeton, NJ	Site of the legacy Princeton Battlefield and the landmark 1772 Thomas Clark House structural site.
Philadelphia, PA	Wartime capital where Washington and Rochambeau paraded joint regiments on August 30, 1781.
Meadowood, VA	Active Bureau of Land Management (BLM) archaeological area containing verified subsurface French camp remains.
Yorktown, VA	The ultimate terminus; location of the climactic trenches and the formal capitulation of British forces.

4. Technical Design & User Experience Implementation Brief

To optimize this data for high web traffic and deep user discovery, implement the following criteria:

- **Unified NPS Iconography:** Incorporate official National Park Service 'WARO' identifiers (the standard 24x24 inch directional brown shield asset) as map pins.
- **Geospatial Layering:** Ensure maps separate the primary vehicle driving routes from multi-use hiking segments, such as the wooded trails in the Meadowood Special Recreation Area.
- **Dynamic Milestones:** Embed specific interactive calendar reminders for foundational historic anniversaries (e.g., March 30, 2009 for trail designation; August 30, 1781 for the Philadelphia arrival) to drive digital engagement.

5. Content Sources & Verifiable Material Links

Web Content Authors can confidently point domain back-links to the following primary authorities:

- **National Park Service (NPS)** – Official administrative manager of the Washington-Rochambeau National Historic Trail portal.
- **Bureau of Land Management (BLM)** – Repository for ongoing historical archaeology and preservation files (particularly for Virginia sectors).
- **W3R National Association** – The lead non-profit community partner supplying state-by-state driving itineraries and historical road-marker databases.